

ICU Team Update

October 2026 | Critical Care, Midland Metropolitan University Hospital

Key headlines only. Full detail, links, images and audio: see the online newsletter.

RESEARCH CORNER

RELEASE: use the standard PaO₂ for P:F

Trial HQ advice: use the **non-temperature-corrected** PaO₂ from the blood gas analyser (measured at 37°C). The corrected value is an estimate and can push a patient across an eligibility threshold.

RELEASE: 10th participant randomised

Midland Metropolitan has randomised 10 participants. Certificate dated 17 September 2026.

ABBRUPT extended

Funder approval received. Recruitment continues to **30 April 2029**; trial end date 31 January 2030.

100 enrolled in 2026

100 patients enrolled January to August. Last year's total was 119. In August: 24 screened, 6 recruited.

Research Hub

Trials, leads and a quick screening tool: swb-icu.github.io/research

TEAM NEWS

Deputy specialty lead

Dr Kieran Donnelly becomes deputy specialty lead for critical care from 1 October.

Congratulations

Dr Ahmed Mokhtar: CESR approved. Ella Skingle (ACCP): MSc with distinction. Kayleigh (ACCP): FUSIC lung ultrasound accreditation.

Flu vaccinations

From 1 October. Clinics on ITU with Vanessa, Cath and Sharon Clarke.

Diary

5K fun run: Sat 3 Oct, 9am, Edgbaston Reservoir. ITU Christmas Party: Sat 19 Dec, The Studio at The Highfield (£10 deposit to Helen Hunt).

CLINICAL UPDATES

RRT fluid balance terms

Cycling, zero, negative, positive, judged in 12-hour blocks (0000-1200h, 1200-0000h). If no endpoint is given at set-up, run zero balance.

AnchorFast is our standard ETT securement

Use for most intubated patients (up to 7 days). **Proning** = **AnchorFast OFF**: use ETT tapes before turning. Guideline: MyDoc 3493 (also Connect and SPARC).

Tracheostomy weaning

Extubation checklist criteria (PS 5 / PEEP 5) are **not** for tracheostomy patients. Wean in a structured, graduated way.

NSE after cardiac arrest

Send at 48 and 72 h post-ROSC, yellow top, "Chemistry send-away test". Discuss with the duty biochemist each time (01902 695 290). Above 60 µg/L points to poor prognosis, alongside other findings.

Donor optimisation bundle

Live. Enter "brain stem death" in diagnosis / problems to activate.

Pupillometer

Acquired brain injury pathways only. Pen torch for everyone else.

TRAINING

APRV survey: last call

Two minutes, anonymous. Link in the online newsletter.

ICU discharge proforma QRG

Prep discharges on the night shift. Steps 7 and 34 are often missed.

Corridor candle

A patient is dying: keep the area calm and respectful for family and friends.

SAFETY & QUALITY

Duty of Candour

Moderate to severe harm or death. (1) Speak and record on Safeguard ASAP. (2) Confirm in writing within 10 working days. (3) Share the final outcome within 10 working days. Advice: swbh.patientsafety@nhs.net

Reaching the SHOs and Registrar

Bleep Registrar 6139, SHO 1 6136, SHO 2 5305. Emergency: 2222 and ask for a fast-bleep.

HLH audit

Interested? Contact Dr Uke (p.uke@nhs.net).

OPERATIONAL & LOOKING AHEAD

New Glidescopes

One per zone, live from 23 September. Blade connections differ from theatres; use a rigid stylet with hyperangulated blades. CMACs being phased out. Questions: Dr Wasim Mir.

24/7 telephone interpreting

Dial 0203 322 6365. Ask your shift coordinator for the access codes.